the visiting SPDPR [Society for the Protection of Detainees and Prisoners Rights] members for books.

There is a campaign in your defence . . .

I am obliged, and really moved by the thousands of people who came forward saying that injustice has been done to me. The lawyers, students, writers, intellectuals, and all the other people involved are doing something great by speaking against injustice. The situation was such in the beginning, in 2001 and the initial days of the case, it was impossible for justice-loving people to come forward. After the High Court acquitted S.A.R. Geelani, people started questioning the police theory. And when more and more people became aware of the case details and facts and started seeing things beyond the lies, they began speaking up. It is natural . . .

Members of your family have conflicting opinions on your case.

My wife has been consistently saying that I was wrongly framed. She has seen how the STF tortured me and did not allow me to live a normal life. She also knew how they implicated me in the case. She wants me to see our son Ghalib growing up. I also have an elder brother who apparently is speaking against me under duress from the STF. It is unfortunate, that's all I can say. See, it is a reality in Kashmir now—what you call counter insurgency operations take any dirty shape. They field brother against brother, neighbour against neighbour. [They] are breaking a society with [their] dirty tricks.

What comes to your mind when you think of your wife Tabassum and son Ghalib?

This year is the tenth anniversary of our wedding. Over half that period I have spent in jail. And prior to that, I was detained many a time and tortured by the Indian security forces in Kashmir. Tabassum witnessed both my physical and mental wounds. I would return from the torture camp unable to stand [after] all kinds of torture, including electric shocks . . . she gave me hope to live . . .